

Logitech WingMan Attack 2

Features: Two-axis control, USB interface, six programmable buttons
Price: Rs 1,399 **Contact:** Aditya Infotech Ltd
Phone: 022-26338555 **E-mail:** sunil_zarekar@adityagroup.com
Web site: www.logitech.com

The WingMan Attack 2's jet black colour with a light grey base makes it stand out from the crowd. Silver buttons with a little blue thrown in, highlight the base. It offers a good grip, large rest pad and an angular thumb rest pad, much like the rest of the Logitech line-up. The base is unusually heavy, imparting a very stable feel and making it durable. The ball joint is stiff and needs a firm push to jerk it around, making the stick less responsive while playing an intense game. One good feature is that the joint is covered by a leather sheet, making it impervious to dust and grime. The head assembly consists of only one button and a hat-switch is sorely missed when playing a flight simulation game.

This joystick has a good build quality with a stable base, well-laid out buttons and an overall good game response. Costing Rs 1,399, it feels a tad expensive when considered alongside other joysticks that offer features such as hat-switch, two extra buttons and the most important—third axis for Rs 200 less.



Logitech WingMan Attack 2		B+
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Logitech WingMan Strike Force

Features: Force Feedback, seven programmable buttons, one clickable scroll wheel, three-axis control, two programmable hat-switches, slide throttle **Price:** Rs 6,999 **Contact:** Aditya Infotech Ltd
Phone: 022-26338555 **E-mail:** sunil_zarekar@adityagroup.com
Web site: www.logitech.com

Logitech has worked hard to make the WingMan Strike Force 3D a flawless gaming peripheral. The placement of buttons is ideal and the clickable scroll wheel swaps weapons rapidly. The thumb fits firmly on the sliding throttle which has a good amount of throw angle.



However, the design is not ambidextrous. The base is quite heavy and the force feedback effects are sharp and quite realistic. But they lack the bite that Microsoft devices offer. This stick also has sensors that cut out feedback when the stick is not held.

It however, lacks refined sensitivity.

The installation was a breeze with Logitech's WingMan profiler program handling everything from installation to calibration. Although not very intuitive, the software is simple to configure and use. You can set force feedback effects and dead zone settings and can also test the variety of force effects assigned to the buttons.

WingMan Strike Force 3D comes at a heavy price of Rs 6,999, and falls in the league of expensive gaming devices.

Logitech WingMan Strike Force 3D		A-
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Logitech WingMan Force 3D

Features: Force feedback, seven programmable buttons, a concave hat-switch, three-axis control **Price:** Rs 4,999 **Contact:** Aditya Infotech Ltd
Phone: 022-26338555 **E-mail:** sunil_zarekar@adityagroup.com
Web site: www.logitech.com

This WingMan Force 3D has a button layout similar to that of the Strike Force 3D with the missing scroll wheel button and a more compact base.

The trigger button and secondary fire buttons are very responsive and a delight to use during rapid fire sessions. The force feedback effects are average and not very pronounced or precise as in the WingMan Strike Force 3D. The stick also features a third axis for perfect rudder control. It uses a USB interface to connect itself to a PC, and does not support a game port. An external adapter takes care of the force feedback power requirements.

With a price tag of Rs 4,999 and awkwardly placed buttons, the device is expensive for the features that are on offer. In case you don't want a force feedback joystick, try the WingMan Extreme digital 3D that sports the same design and button layout but does not incorporate force feedback while offering game port connectivity.



Logitech WingMan Force 3D		B+
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Microsoft Sidewinder Force Feedback 2

Features: USB interface, force feedback, three-axis control, hat-switch, eight programmable buttons **Price:** Rs 7,500
Contact: Trifen Technologies **Phone:** 022-26236061/6226777
E-mail: trifen@vsnl.com **Web site:** www.microsoft.com

The first welcome detail in the new SideWinder is the power adapter at the base of the stick that lets you connect the stick directly to a power outlet. The base is made of a granular material for a good grip and the small rubber pegs sit it firmly on the table even when jerked around.

The force feedback effects were pronounced, with every small force being directed to the stick precisely. Two smart sensors stop the feedback the moment your hand leaves the stick. Like every Microsoft product, you just have to plug the stick to a USB port and load the accompanying drivers. The SideWinder game controller software shows the various settings for the forces graphically. If you have a VIA chipset, you need to install a small patch for the force feed to work properly.

This is the ultimate gaming device money can buy. With a price tag of Rs 7,500 it is too expensive for all but the discerning gamer.



Microsoft Force Feedback 2		A-
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	